

Credit Control and Arrears Management Procedure

Organisation	North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU)
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Document control note: users must confirm status and effective date before relying on a rule. Superseded documents are retained in this synthetic corpus deliberately so that retrieval pipelines can be tested for version awareness.

1. Purpose and Member Treatment

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies purpose and member treatment in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
1.1	The objective is to restore sustainable payment where possible while identifying cases requiring specialist support, forbearance or recovery.
1.2	Arrears treatment must distinguish inability to pay, unwillingness to pay, operational error and disputed balance.
1.3	Members must not be disadvantaged by a credit-union-caused collection failure while the failure is being investigated.

Control 1. The objective is to restore sustainable payment where possible while identifying cases requiring specialist support, forbearance or recovery. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Arrears treatment must distinguish inability to pay, unwillingness to pay, operational error and disputed balance. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Members must not be disadvantaged by a credit-union-caused collection failure while the failure is being investigated. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

2. Days Past Due Segmentation

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies days past due segmentation in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
2.1	Accounts 1 to 7 days past due receive an early reminder unless payment is known to be in transit.
2.2	Accounts 8 to 30 days past due require an outbound contact attempt and an assessment of the reason for missed payment.
2.3	Accounts 31 to 60 days past due require a documented treatment plan and consideration of affordability or vulnerability.
2.4	Accounts 61 to 90 days past due require senior review and consideration of formal forbearance, recovery or impairment actions.
2.5	Accounts above 90 days past due enter the serious arrears process and must be included in enhanced reporting.

Control 1. Accounts 1 to 7 days past due receive an early reminder unless payment is known to be in transit. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Accounts 8 to 30 days past due require an outbound contact attempt and an assessment of the reason for missed payment. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Accounts 31 to 60 days past due require a documented treatment plan and consideration of affordability or vulnerability. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 4. Accounts 61 to 90 days past due require senior review and consideration of formal forbearance, recovery or impairment actions. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 5. Accounts above 90 days past due enter the serious arrears process and must be included in enhanced reporting. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule

that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

3. Contact Strategy and Service Levels

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies contact strategy and service levels in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
3.1	At least 80 percent of accounts requiring contact should have a completed meaningful contact or documented contact outcome within five working days of entering the treatment queue.
3.2	Repeated unsuccessful contact must use proportionate alternative channels and must respect recorded communication preferences.
3.3	Contact attempts must be recorded with date, channel, outcome and next action.

Control 1. At least 80 percent of accounts requiring contact should have a completed meaningful contact or documented contact outcome within five working days of entering the treatment queue. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Repeated unsuccessful contact must use proportionate alternative channels and must respect recorded communication preferences. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Contact attempts must be recorded with date, channel, outcome and next action. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

4. Payment Arrangements and Forbearance

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies payment arrangements and forbearance in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
4.1	A payment arrangement must be based on a realistic assessment of what the member can sustain.
4.2	Temporary reduced payments, payment dates and review dates must be recorded.
4.3	A broken arrangement must trigger reassessment rather than automatic repetition of the same arrangement.

Control 1. A payment arrangement must be based on a realistic assessment of what the member can sustain. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Temporary reduced payments, payment dates and review dates must be recorded. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. A broken arrangement must trigger reassessment rather than automatic repetition of the same arrangement. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

5. Payroll Deduction Failures

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies payroll deduction failures in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent

review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
5.1	Where a payroll file or employer deduction failure affects multiple members, Credit Control must identify the affected population before treating the missed payment as member conduct.
5.2	Affected members should receive consistent communication explaining the operational issue and any action required.
5.3	Fees, adverse treatment or escalation caused solely by a confirmed credit-union or employer file-processing failure must be corrected.
5.4	The incident owner must provide a reconciliation of expected versus received deductions.

Control 1. Where a payroll file or employer deduction failure affects multiple members, Credit Control must identify the affected population before treating the missed payment as member conduct. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Affected members should receive consistent communication explaining the operational issue and any action required. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Fees, adverse treatment or escalation caused solely by a confirmed credit-union or employer file-processing failure must be corrected. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 4. The incident owner must provide a reconciliation of expected versus received deductions. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

6. Vulnerability and Complaints

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies vulnerability and complaints in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
6.1	Signs of vulnerability identified during arrears contact must be handled under the vulnerable-member process.
6.2	A member dispute about an arrears balance must be investigated before irreversible recovery action.
6.3	Complaint indicators must be referred without using the complaints process as a reason to stop necessary account protection.

Control 1. Signs of vulnerability identified during arrears contact must be handled under the vulnerable-member process. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. A member dispute about an arrears balance must be investigated before irreversible recovery action. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Complaint indicators must be referred without using the complaints process as a reason to stop necessary account protection. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

7. Management Information and Thresholds

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies management information and thresholds in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
7.1	Monthly MI must include arrears balance, accounts in arrears, PAR30, PAR90, cure rate, roll rate, contact completion, arrangements and recoveries.
7.2	Contact completion below 70 percent for a monthly cycle is an amber operational-risk indicator and below 55 percent is red.
7.3	A rise in PAR30 of more than 1 percentage point month-on-month requires root-cause analysis.
7.4	Early arrears should be segmented by origination cohort and repayment channel.

Control 1. Monthly MI must include arrears balance, accounts in arrears, PAR30, PAR90, cure rate, roll rate, contact completion, arrangements and recoveries. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. Contact completion below 70 percent for a monthly cycle is an amber operational-risk indicator and below 55 percent is red. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. A rise in PAR30 of more than 1 percentage point month-on-month requires root-cause analysis. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 4. Early arrears should be segmented by origination cohort and repayment channel. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

8. Quality Assurance and Escalation

This section defines how North Pennine Community Credit Union (NPCU) applies quality assurance and escalation in day-to-day operations. The control intent is to make decisions repeatable, evidenced and capable of independent

review.

Operational teams must record enough evidence for a reviewer to reconstruct the decision without relying on the memory of the original colleague. Where a system rule and a documented policy appear to conflict, the current approved policy takes precedence and the discrepancy must be raised as a change or incident.

Managers are expected to monitor both individual exceptions and emerging patterns. A single exception may be reasonable; a recurring exception can indicate a control design problem, training issue, configuration defect or change in member behaviour.

Ref	Key requirement
8.1	Quality assurance must test treatment appropriateness, evidence quality, vulnerability handling and accuracy of arrears status.
8.2	System or supplier incidents affecting the treatment queue must be logged through operational-risk governance.
8.3	Control failures with portfolio impact require an owner, remediation date and monitoring until closure.

Control 1. Quality assurance must test treatment appropriateness, evidence quality, vulnerability handling and accuracy of arrears status. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 2. System or supplier incidents affecting the treatment queue must be logged through operational-risk governance. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Control 3. Control failures with portfolio impact require an owner, remediation date and monitoring until closure. The case record must show the information relied upon, the outcome, the colleague or automated rule that made the decision, and any approval required. Evidence should be captured at the point of decision rather than reconstructed later.

Quality assurance should test a representative sample of cases against this control. Where an error could affect a member financially, regulatory obligations, data integrity or the accuracy of management reporting, the issue must be corrected promptly and considered for wider impact assessment.

Management information for this area should distinguish volume, value, exception rate and outcome. Trend analysis must consider whether movements are driven by portfolio growth, mix changes, operational incidents or genuine deterioration in member outcomes.

End of synthetic document